

Auroracoin. As a result, beers in Iceland were being purchased for auroracoin,<sup>43</sup> and many other retail establishments began to utilize the cryptocurrency. Then a scandal hit and the prime minister was forced to resign because of his involvement with the Panama Papers.<sup>44</sup> This led to the growth in popularity of a political party known as the Pirate Party, which had a favorable view on cryptocurrencies.<sup>45</sup> Suddenly there was speculation<sup>46</sup> that Iceland could revisit the potential for Auroracoin and its role as a national cryptocurrency.<sup>47</sup> As acceptance grows and politics change, it will be interesting to watch what happens next for the Icelandic cryptocurrency.

Auroracoin is a cautionary tale for both investors and developers. What began as a seemingly powerful and compelling use case for a cryptoasset suffered from its inability to provide value to the audience it sought to impact. Icelanders were given a cryptocurrency with little education and means to use it. Unsurprisingly, the value of the asset collapsed and most considered it dead. Nevertheless, cryptocurrencies rarely die entirely, and Auroracoin may have interesting times ahead if its developer team can figure out a way forward.

## **THE RACE FOR PRIVACY: DASH, MONERO, AND ZCASH**

While Litecoin, Ripple, and Dogecoin all added elements to the mix of what it meant to be a cryptocurrency, they did not